Module 1
Introduction to Modern Art & Ideas

Module 2
Places & Spaces

Module 3
Art & Identity

Module 4
Transforming Everyday Objects

Introduction to Transforming Everyday Objects
- Welcome to Module 4 — Reading • 10 min
- Transforming Everyday Objects — Video • 4 min

Transforming How Objects Look
- How do artists draw from their surroundings? — Reading • 20 min
- Ruth Asawa. Untitled (BMC. 145, BMC Laundry Stamp). c. 1948-49 — Video • 1 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Noah Purifoy. Unknown. 1967 — Video • 2 min

Transforming What Objects Mean
- How do artists alter the meaning of objects? — Reading • 10 min
- Alfonso Ossorio. Empty Chair or The Last Colonial. 1969 — Video • 2 min
- Practical Scenario — Real-world application • 5 min
- Diamond Stingily. Entryways. 2021 — Video • 1 min

Transforming What Objects Do
- How do designers problem-solve? — Reading • 10 min
- Clara Porset. Butaque Chair. 1957 — Video • 2 min
- Tomás Gabzdil Libertiny. The Honeycomb Vase "Made by Bees" (Prototype). 2006 — Video • 2 min

Review & Reflect
- Optional Readings & Resources — Reading • 10 min
- Assessment:Transforming Everyday Objects — Dialogue • 15 min
- Optional Prompts for Discussion & Reflection — Reading • 10 min

Module 5
Module 5: Art & Society

Module 6
Course Conclusion

How do artists draw from their surroundings?

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Meret Oppenheim. *Object*. 1936. Fur-covered cup, saucer, and spoon; cup 4 3/8" (10.9 cm) diam.; saucer 9 3/8" (23.7 cm) diam.; spoon 8" (20.2 cm) long, overall height 2 7/8" (7.3 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Purchase. © 2016 Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York/Pro Litteris, Zurich

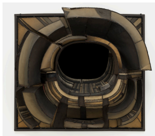
It began with a joke over lunch. In 1936, Meret Oppenheim was at a Paris café with Dora Maar and Pablo Picasso, who noticed the fur-lined, polished metal bracelet she was wearing and joked that anything could be covered with fur. "Even this cup and saucer," Oppenheim replied and, carrying the merriment further, called out, "Waiter, a little more fur!" With her imagination sparked, the artist went to a department store not long after this meal, bought a white teacup, saucer, and spoon, wrapped them in the fur of an antelope , and titled this ensemble *Object*. The materials in this small Surrealist object evoke an unexpected combination of associations—from wild animals to etiquette rituals.



Robert Rauschenberg. *Bed*. 1955. Oil and pencil on pillow, quilt, and sheet on wood supports, 6' 3 1/4" x 31 1/2" x 8" (191.1 x 80 x 20.3 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of Leo Castelli in honor of Alfred H. Barr, Jr. © 2016 Robert Rauschenberg Foundation/Licensed by VAGA, New York, NY

Abstract Expressionism dominated the New York City art scene when Robert Rauschenberg was getting his start as an artist. But he challenged these artists' conception of their work as personal expressions, separate from the outside world. He did this through works like *Bed*, which is one of his first combines —a term used to describe compositions combining elements of painting and sculpture. Combines often included found objects such as tires, furniture, trash, and taxidermy animals.

To make this work, Rauschenberg took a well-worn pillow, sheet, and quilt, attached them to wooden supports, and vigorously scribbled and painted on them, poking fun at the gestural mark making of Abstract Expressionist painting. Hung vertically on the wall, *Bed* embodies the artist's assertion that "painting relates to both art and life… I try to act in that gap between the two."



Lee Bontecou. *Untitled*. 1961. Welded steel, canvas, fabric, rawhide, copper wire, and soot. 6' 8 1/4" x 7' 5" x 34 3/4" (203.6 x 226 x 88 cm). Kay Sage Tanguy Fund. © 2024 Lee Bontecou

To make this untitled work, Lee Bontecou took canvas from conveyor belts discarded by a laundromat below her East Village apartment in New York City, and stretched the pieces across a steel armature. The artwork straddles the lines between painting and sculpture, mechanical and organic, and inviting and threatening. The void at the center may evoke an airplane's jet engine, which she said was an inspiration for her work, it also reflects the evolution of Bontecou's practice: "I was trying to search out for my own language, my own statement. I started to try to get a space that could go endless."



Claes Oldenburg. *Floor Cone*. 1962. Synthetic polymer paint on canvas filled with foam rubber and cardboard boxes. 53 3/4" x 11' 4" x 56" (136.5 x 345.4 x 142 cm). Gift of Philip Johnson. © 2024 Claes Oldenburg

In December 1961, Claes Oldenburg rented a small storefront in Lower Manhattan and filled it with handmade, brightly painted objects that recalled the shirts, watches, sausages, slices of pie available for purchase in stores throughout the neighborhood. This marked the beginning of a project called The Store. The second iteration took place in Midtown Manhattan. Taking advantage of the larger square footage available to him, the artist exhibited oversize soft sculptures sewn by his wife, Patty Mucha, and painted by Oldenburg: an ice-cream cone, a piece of cake, and a hamburger. Mucha recalls taking the sculpture for a drive in a pickup truck and receiving a warm reception from children in passing cars, who "shouted out their approval."



G. Peter Jemison. *Art Bag*. 1980. Crayon, oil pastel, fabric, rope, plastic tag, jigsaw puzzle piece, and ticket with oil paint on printed brown paper bag with three printed metal pins and a business card inside, 20 × 13 × 7" (50.8 × 33 × 17.8 cm). Frances Keech Fund

G. Peter Jemison, citizen of the Seneca Nation, Heron Clan, was inspired to work with bags after noticing them while commuting in New York City. "The common denominator for those of us who traveled on the subway from Brooklyn to Manhattan every day was that we carried some kind of bag—a plastic bag, a shopping bag, a briefcase, a handbag, a lunch bag." Recycling paper bags, he painted images referencing nature, personal stories, perceptions of Indigenous peoples in North America, as well as Haudenosaunee history and art practices like quillwork and beading. "*Indian Toy / Toy Indian* was a sort of a manufactured image of what we look like," Jemison reflects. "And then placing it on a paper bag, and the paper bag is a commercial object. It's a little bit of a tongue in cheek commentary about the way in which everything is commercialized, including us, including our image."

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